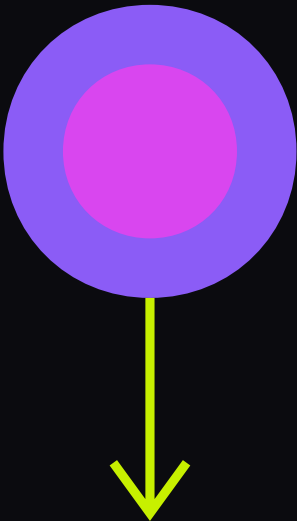


# DOMAIN ADMINS MEMBERSHIP ADDITION

Detects an account being added to the Domain Admins global group by filtering its stable RID 512. Every result requires approved-change validation.

PRODUCTION CANDIDATE

CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM



SecurityEvent / Event ID 4728

Behavioral

EVIDENCE BEFORE ALERTING

REPORT DATE

12 September 2026

STATUS

Untested implementation  
sketch

PRIMARY PLATFORM

Microsoft Sentinel

OPERATIONAL VALUE

9.7 / 10



# EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Decision-grade summary and evidence boundary.

ASSESSMENT

## OPERATIONAL VALUE

9.7

Detects an account being added to the Domain Admins global group by filtering its stable RID 512. Every result requires approved-change validation.

## CLASSIFICATION

### Production candidate

Production candidate - Untested implementation sketch; Confidence Medium.

1primary table  
0thresholds  
0joins  
0secondary rules

### Source fact

GreyNoise directly observed an adversary-created account added to Domain Admins.

### Analytical choice

Windows Event ID 4728 records additions to security-enabled global groups.

### Constraint

Microsoft documents RID 512 as unique to Domain Admins in each AD domain.

### Evidence boundary

A result does not prove PaperCut exploitation, actor ownership, DCSync, credential theft, or follow-on impact.



# THREAT MECHANICS

Observed behavior and bounded analytical interpretation.

BEHAVIOR

## 01 Initial access

PaperCut NG/MF exploitation begins the reported intrusion.

→

## 02 Observed behavior

GreyNoise directly observed an adversary-created account added to Domain Admins.

→

## 03 Detection pivot

Detects an account being added to the Domain Admins global group by filtering its stable RID 512. Every result requires approved-change validation.

| Evidence layer    | Supported statement                                    |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Publication       | GreyNoise, 09 Sep 2026.                                |
| Observed activity | 31 Aug 2026 onward; final observation date not stated. |
| Logic type        | Behavioral                                             |
| ATT&CK            | T1098.007 Additional Local or Domain Groups            |

### Hypothesis

If an attacker adds an account to Domain Admins, Domain Controller telemetry should show Event ID 4728 with TargetSid ending in -512. Approved change evidence and operator provenance distinguish legitimate administration.



# TELEMETRY AND DATA CONTRACT

Minimum collection and field requirements.

TELEMETRY

REQUIRED

Windows Security events from every writable Domain Controller; Audit Security Group Management; Windows Security Events via AMA.

OPTIONAL ENRICHMENT

Approved change records, PAM workflow, operator workstation inventory, recent logons and identity risk.

| Fields                           | Reliability | Purpose                   |
|----------------------------------|-------------|---------------------------|
| EventID, TimeGenerated, Computer | Documented  | Event identity and source |
| TargetSid                        | Documented  | Domain Admins RID filter  |
| MemberName, MemberSid            | Documented  | Added principal           |
| SubjectAccount, SubjectUserSid   | Documented  | Initiator                 |
| SubjectLogonId, TargetAccount    | Documented  | Investigation pivots      |

**Collection boundary**

No payload, hive content, inferred success, rarity score, or undocumented field is used.



# PRIMARY DETECTION LOGIC

Direct source-supported conditions and investigative output.

KQL

STATUS

Production candidate - Untested implementation sketch

KQL - UNTESTED

```
SecurityEvent
| where EventID == 4728
| where TargetSid endswith "-512"
| project TimeGenerated, Computer, EventID, Activity,
    SubjectAccount, SubjectUserSid, SubjectLogonId,
    TargetAccount, TargetDomainName, TargetSid,
    MemberName, MemberSid
| order by TimeGenerated desc
```

| THRESHOLD | WINDOW | JOIN | AGGREGATION | STATUS   |
|-----------|--------|------|-------------|----------|
| None      | None   | None | None        | Untested |



# TRIAGE AND FALSE POSITIVES

Evidence needed before escalation.

WORKFLOW

1

## Preserve raw event

Retain all projected identifiers and command context.

2

## Confirm provenance

Identify operator, host role, ticket and management path.

3

## Collect enrichment

Approved change records, PAM workflow, operator workstation inventory, recent logons and identity risk.

4

## Assess scope

Review adjacent identity, endpoint and PaperCut evidence.

### Expected benign overlap

Legitimate IAM/PAM work, break-glass changes, migrations, and emergency administration. Do not permanently allowlist privileged operators.

### Response boundary

A result does not prove PaperCut exploitation, actor ownership, DCSync, credential theft, or follow-on impact.



# VALIDATION GATES

Controlled testing and cross-SIEM constraints.

QUALITY CONTROL

## Validation steps

- 1. Create a controlled global-group change and confirm field population.
- 2. During an approved window, add and remove a test account from Domain Admins.
- 3. Compare 30 days of results with change records and authorized operators.
- 4. Confirm coverage from every writable Domain Controller.

## Decision criteria

**Success:** Every controlled Domain Admins addition returns one usable event with group, member and initiator evidence.

**Rejection:** TargetSid does not contain the group SID or the filter returns non-equivalent groups.

**Failure:** Auditing, connector, retention, DC coverage or required fields are unavailable.

| Platform           | Decision                   | Missing evidence                                  |
|--------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Microsoft Sentinel | Production candidate       | Target-environment execution and baseline         |
| Splunk             | No reliable implementation | Index, sourcetype, field extraction, sample event |
| Chronicle          | No reliable implementation | Parser, UDM event type and exact field mapping    |



# CONCLUSION AND REFERENCES

Coverage statement and document control.

FINAL

## CONCLUSION

### Production candidate

Detects an account being added to the Domain Admins global group by filtering its stable RID 512. Every result requires approved-change validation.

A result does not prove PaperCut exploitation, actor ownership, DCSync, credential theft, or follow-on impact.

## MITRE ATT&CK

T1098.007 Additional Local or Domain Groups

## References

1. GreyNoise, 09 Sep 2026 - AI-Orchestrated Global Campaign Against PaperCut NG/MF
2. PaperCut, updated 10 Sep 2026 - NG/MF urgent security advisory
3. Microsoft Learn - Audit Security Group Management and Event 4728
4. Microsoft Learn - SecurityEvent table and Security Identifiers
5. MITRE ATT&CK - T1098.007

## Document control

English dossier. No customer data. URLs are defanged in references.txt. HTML and rendering assets remain private.